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by AvatarBea

Summary

Catra and Adora go to different colleges in different cities, meaning they don't get to be there for each other as much as they would like to be. So when Adora visits Catra for the winter break, they catch up with each other and discuss what their future together looks like.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra rubbed the tears from her eyes, embarrassed that she was so upset. “I just really wish you were here.”

“Me too honey,” Adora assured through their video call. “It kills me to be away from you. But we’ll see each other soon. The holidays are coming up, remember?”

“It still feels so far away. I know why you had to go to Brightmoon, I really do. It had the best school for you. And I know I had to stay here for college. It just still sucks.”

“Trust me, I know,” the blonde said, crying tears of her own. “It totally sucks. Part of me just wants to just drop everything and come home to you right now.”

“But,” the part-feline sniffled, “but you've been telling me about all the friends you’re making. Like Sparkles and Arrow Boy.”

“Well those aren’t their actual names, but let’s ignore that for the time being. Yes, we’ve been hanging out and I do like them, but they can’t compete with my awesome girlfriend. They don’t know me the way you do. I honestly don’t think anyone ever will.”

“I feel like it’d be easier if I had someone around here to hang out with, a friend or two. But everyone at Fright Zone University hates me.”

“I’m sure they don’t hate you-“

“It certainly feels like they do. And who can blame them? I’m snippy and cold-hearted and weird.”

“You are none of those things Catra. You are caring and assertive and funny and the reason my days are filled with so much joy. I know making friends is a struggle for you, but it’ll happen. You’re going to find your people and have an amazing time getting to know them. Anyone at that school would be lucky to have you be their friend, I know I am. Don’t give up on yourself yet- don’t

forget just how special you are. Before you know it, I'll be home for the holidays and back in your arms."

"You promise?"

"I promise."

————————-a few months later————————

The second Catra heard a knock on her apartment door, she swung it open and scooped up the blonde in front of her, forcing the other to let out a squeal of surprise and delight.

"I take it you're happy to see me?" Adora said with a smile.

The brunette let the other female down, snorting and playfully rolling her eyes. "You wish. I barely noticed you were gone."

"But Catra," Entrapta started as the two approached her in the apartment, "isn't this the Adora you mention at least three times a day? The one you asked me to set up a countdown on your phone for so you knew how close she was to coming here?"

The part-feline furiously blushed. "That did not happen."

"Yes it did. I logged it in my observation recordings."

Adora gave a light chuckle. "I'm assuming you are Entrapta?"

"Correct. Scorpia should be here soon, she wanted to do some last-minute holiday shopping."

The newcomer raised her eyebrow. "So there is a very real possibility that Catra would've just now pounced on her friend had she been the one at the door?"

"And she would've loved it," her girlfriend insisted. "Scorpia's always going on about how I should be more affectionate."

"Well I happen to agree. As your girlfriend I'm going to demand the cuddles I was so wrongfully deprived of all these months."

Catra took her lover's hand and gave it a squeeze. "I think we can work something out."

All of the sudden, the apartment door swung open and in burst a part-scorpion woman, whose very muscular arms were holding loads of shopping bags.

The new person gasped when they saw the blonde. "Wildcat, is this Adora? She's gorgeous- your iPhone wallpaper doesn't do her justice!"

Adora glanced at her partner, a smug look on her face. "I'm your wallpaper?"

"It's the photo of you drooling all over Melog while you cuddle them in your sleep. Not exactly flattering."

"That's okay. My wallpaper is of you reacting to me mentioning the word 'mouse'."

"Are you ever going to let that go!?"

"Nope."

Before the two women's banter could continue, the blonde found herself being scooped up in the part-scorpion's arms.

"I hope you don't mind. Catra should've warned you that I'm a hugger."

The blue-eyed beauty laughed. "She may have mentioned it once or twice.

"She also mentioned that you love going to the gym," Adora continued as she was let out of the other's embrace, "so I was thinking one day this week we could go there together."

"Absolutely! I'm always trying to get Catra to go with me, but she makes up some excuse every time."

“I know the feeling. Throughout our entire relationship, she’s never once been on a run with me.”

“You run at five o’clock in the morning!” the part-feline protested. “That’s way too early!”

“So, if I ran in the afternoons, you’d go with me?”

“No, but that’s not what we’re talking about right now!”

The four woman all fell into an easy rhythm together, helping Scorpia unload all of her holiday items- the ones she let the group see at least. After that, they got Chinese food and sat in the apartment’s small but cozy living room, discussing what the past few months have been like for them.

“So,” Adora began, picking up her container of chicken fried rice, “are you guys in any clubs together?”

“Scorpia and I are in the robotics club,” Entrapta replied. “Catra went to three meetings and then never came back.” “Catra!” the blonde exclaimed, giving her girlfriend’s shoulder a small swat.

The brunette took a sip of her drink, shrugging. “I went to a whole bunch of clubs the first month or so of school, trying to be social and all. Most of them weren’t for me.”

“Most of them?”

“Wildcat’s captain of the debate team,” Scorpia explained.

“Of course you are,” the blonde said, turning to her girlfriend with a gentle smile. “You’ve always had a way with words.”

“I just love to be right.”

“That too.”

“There’s actually a debate this weekend,” the part-scorpion added. “It’s open to the public, you should come with us and watch Catra

do her thing."

Adora gasped, giving her girlfriend a look of pure betrayal. "You didn't tell me anything about this!"

"It's just a mock debate between us and another local college," the part-feline reasoned. "It doesn't even count for the season, just for people who want something to do over the break."

"Doesn't matter, I want to go!"

Catra shrugged, pretending to not be giddy over how supportive her girlfriend was being. "Suit yourself."

"And then we can all go out for ice cream afterwards to celebrate you being such an excellent debater."

"It'll be like thirty degrees outside Adora."

"Hasn't stop me before, won't be stopping me now."

"Oh! We should go to Harmony's Delights," Scorpia happily interjected. "They have the best homemade cupcakes and ice cream in the area."

"Not to mention the floral hippie cashier that you're completely infatuated with," Catra added smugly as she picked up a spring roll.

The white-haired woman's face turned beat red. "I am not infatuated with her! Perfuma's just a good friend."

"I don't believe you for one minute. You are attracted to her just as much as she's attracted to you."

"… you think she's attracted to me?" "Scorpia! She literally invited you to spend the night with her last week!"

"As a friends kind of thing!"

The brunette sighed and turned to her other friend from college. "Entrapta, did Perfuma's request seem to be a 'friends kind of thing' to you?"

"Definitely not. Given Perfuma's body language, constant touching of Scorpia's arms, and obvious despair at Scorpia's rejection, she was looking for something more than friendship."

"And there you have it," the part-feline stated with finality, giving Entrapta a fist bump for good measure. "She's got the hots for you."

"You should ask her out," Adora encouraged. "You'll never know what could happen between the two of you if you don't take a chance."

Catra snorted. "Says the woman who spent years pining for me and waited til I confessed to tell me she felt the same."

"Hey, you spent years pining for me too! And maybe I'm just trying to help somebody learn from our mistakes."

"I appreciate all you guys are saying, I really do," Scorpia said shyly, "but I doubt asking her out would go well, I'm not really the leading lady type."

"I don't buy that for a second," Adora stated. "I've only known you for less than a day and I already think your amazing."

"And Adora's a great judge of character," the part-feline added. "I mean obviously, look who she ended up with. You deserve everything good that comes your way, Scorps, and I think you'll be pleasantly surprised if take that leap of faith and ask Flower Princess out. But we will do our best not to pressure you until your ready."

The part-scorpion beamed at her friends words, tears starting to well up in her eyes. "Thanks Wildcat. Come here!"

Suddenly, the brunette was picked up from her seat and enveloped in a bone-crushing hug by her friend.

————————--Later That Night————————-

Catra purred contently as she placed her head into the crook of her girlfriends's neck, both of them ready to head off to sleep.

"You have no idea how much I've missed this," she whispered.

"Yes I do," Adora insisted lovingly. "I've been dreaming about this since the first night we spent apart."

"I hate that we only have a month together before you've got to go back."

Her partner sighed at the idea. "Let's not think about that right now. We're here, we're together, and that's all that matters."

"Yeah," the woman quietly agreed, "that's all that matters."

After a few moments of silence, the blonde announced, "I'm really proud of you."

"Oh yeah? For what?"

"For not giving up on yourself. For putting yourself out there and making friends. They seem really great."

The part-feline reflected on this for a moment. When she had first started college without Adora or anyone else for that matter, it had felt like a nightmare. She always prided herself on not being scared of anything, but being on such a big campus without an anchor had terrified her. The only thing that had gotten her through that time was the daily messages she exchanged with her girlfriend.

But she had eventually found her groove and met two dorks she couldn't imagine spending time without. Scorpia and Entrapta had come on a little strong at first, but that was because they cared so

much. And throughout the whole semester, they pushed her to be better and to go after the things she wanted, such as renting the very apartment she was currently in.

“They’re amazing,” Catra finally responded.

“I don’t doubt it. You don’t pick subpar friends.”

The brunette laughed. “No I do not.”

“I know I don’t know them that well, but I got them each a gift for Christmas- or New Years, if they don’t celebrate that.”

“They celebrate Christmas. Not in a religious way, but they still do all the regular traditions.”

“Okay, cool.”

“I got some gifts for your friends too. If you give me the address for Arrow Boy, I can send it to them this week.”

“You won’t need it- Glimmer finally confessed to Bow about her feelings and they’re spending the entire winter break together at the apartment her and I share.”

“About time!” Catra exclaimed, throwing her hands in the air for emphasis. “I’ve never even met these people and there constant pining for each other was exhausting!”

The blonde giggled. “Well either way, it’s very sweet that you got something for the two of them.”

“I figured I had to pay them back for taking on my duties of making sure you eat and at least try to relax.”

“Y’know, they actually took me to a spa once.”

The brunette raised an eyebrow. “Oh really? How long were you able to just lie down without talking or making an awkward noise to fill the silence?”

"… about thirty seconds. And then I fell asleep in the hot tub."

Catra laughed. "Did you have fun though?"

"I actually did once I took Bow's advice to just enjoy myself and not focus so much on being perfectly still."

"Good. I'm happy things are working out for you in Brightmoon."

"Me too. I really like it there. In fact…."

The part-feline sat up in bed, realizing her girlfriend was wanting to talk about something serious. "What is it?"

"How would you feel about living there together? Once we're both done with college, of course."

"Really? You… you'd want me to move in with you?"

"Of course I would. If it were up to me, we'd be living together right now. But I know that's not what's best for either of us at the present moment, so I've just been focusing on the future. Our future."

Our future. Catra certainly liked the sound of that.

"I've never even been to Brightmoon."

"That's okay! Maybe you can come visit me during some of the school breaks, like for a few weeks this summer. I can introduce you to Bow and Glimmer, show you the sights, take you on cheesy dates."

"You always take me on cheesy dates, no matter the location," she countered.

"I know. Listen, I'm not trying to pressure you into being sold on this idea. This is still years away, and my viewpoint could change in that time. I just wanted to get the conversation started and let

you know I'm serious about this- about us. I fully intend on you being my forever Catra, so long as you feel the same way."

"I do," the woman insisted, smiling softly at the other. "I want you to be my forever too."

Adora breathed a sigh of relief. "Good. That's good to hear."

"You thought I didn't?"

"No! Well… kind of? I may have let my anxiety about us living so far apart get to me just a bit."

"Of course you did," the woman replied, playfully rolling her eyes.

"It's stupid, I know."

"It's not stupid, just very in character for you. But you have nothing to worry about. I love you dummy, more than I've loved anything in my entire life, and the miles that lie between us can't change that."

"I don't really appreciate the dummy part, but I love you too."

"And you know that you can call me whenever you miss me or feel uncertain in our relationship, right? I'm more than happy to assure you."

"You're just so busy with your life here and I don't want to keep you tied to the phone, talking to me."

"Hey, you told me before you left for Brightmoon that I could contact you day or night if I ever needed anything, even if it was just to say hello. That goes both ways. And you could never tie me down."

"I feel like I can. I feel like I'm too needy in this relationship because I'm always scared that the distance will make it hard to show just how much I care about you. Stars, I'm terrified to leave

you when the spring semester starts," Adora admitted, tears building up in her eyes.

"That's weeks away babe."

"Doesn't matter. No amount of time with you is ever enough. I don't know if I can leave you behind."

"Adora," the brunette started seriously, "aside from being away from me, does being in Brightmoon make you unhappy?"

"Well, no. I love the classes I'm taking and the friends I have made and the cool coffee shops I've found. Also the air quality is a lot nicer."

"Then that's where you need to live for now. I'm not going anywhere, I know how much you love me, and you're not leaving me behind- you're furthering your education so you can peruse your dreams. That's fantastic- I couldn't possibly be more proud!"

The blonde gave her a lovingly soft smile.

"And for the record, I'd be honored to move in with you after college and officially start our lives together."

"Really!?" Adora asked, her facial expression resembling that of an excited gold retriever.

"Yes really. But that's not happening for a while, and neither is you going back to Brightmoon for next semester. So I demand we take this time to cuddle and revel fact that we're here together. Sound good?"

The other woman nodded, positioning herself so she was once again wrapped around in her girlfriend's arms, cocooned in the love they have for each other.

After a few minutes of content silence, Adora whispered, "I could stay like this with you forever."

Catra let out a soft purr and dawned a sleepy smile. “Me too Princess. Me too.”

End Notes

Thanks for reading and happy holidays (or happy holigays I should say 😌)!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!